

[online.wsj.com/article_email/SB10001424052748704828104576021481410635432-IMyQjAxMTAwMDEwODEwODEwNDgyWj.html](http://online.wsj.com/article_email/SB10001424052748704828104576021481410635432-IMyQjAxMTAwMDEwODEwNDgyWj.html)

3. The term minimum viable product has been in use since at least 2000 as part of various approaches to product development. For an academic example, see <http://www2.cs.uidaho.edu/~billjunk/Publications/DynamicBalance.pdf>

See also Frank Robinson of PMDI, who refers to a version of the product that is the smallest needed to sell to potential customers (<http://productdevelopment.com/howitworks/mvp.html>). This is similar to Steve Blank's concept of the "minimum feature set" in customer development (<http://steveblank.com/2010/03/04/perfection-by-subtraction-the-minimum-feature-set/>). My use of the term here has been generalized to any version of a product that can begin the process of learning, using the Build-Measure-Learn feedback loop. For more, see <http://www.startuplessonslearned.com/2009/08/minimum-viable-product-guide.html>

4. Many people have written about this phenomenon, using varying terminology. Probably the most widely read is Geoffrey Moore's Crossing the Chasm. For more, see Eric Von Hippel's research into what he termed "lead users"; his book The Sources of Innovation is a great place to start. Steve Blank uses the term earlyvangelist to emphasize the evangelical powers of these early customers.
5. "To the casual observer, the Dropbox demo video looked like a normal product demonstration," Drew says, "but we put in about a dozen Easter eggs that were tailored for the Digg audience. References to Tay Zonday and 'Chocolate Rain' and allusions to Office Space and XKCD. It was a tongue-in-cheek nod to that crowd, and it kicked off a chain reaction. Within 24 hours, the video had more than 10,000 Diggings." <http://answers.oreilly.com/topic/1372-marketing-lessons-from-dropbox-a-qa-with-ceo-drew-houston/>. You can see the original video as well as the reaction from the Digg community at [http://digg.com/software/Google Drive killer coming from MIT Startup](http://digg.com/software/Google_Drive_killer_coming_from_MIT_Startup). For